

Ali El Kaoutri

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To whom it may concern,

My name is Ali, a former VP of **Hand In Hand CSC**, which is part of the American Language Center in Tangier, Morocco.

I am writing to recommend **Afnane Amrani**, who served as President of a club of more than **90 members** during the three years of my volunteering experience, from **2021 to 2023**.

I was a member of the club from 2019 to 2024, and during that time, I progressed from an ordinary member to Talent Manager and, in **2023**, to Vice President. This progression allows me to speak about Afnane's **leadership** with confidence: I witnessed it as a general member, as part of her leadership team, and later as someone responsible for continuing the work she had built.

I joined LFL in **2019** as a member of the Reading Buddies project. When Afnane became President in **2021**, the impact of her leadership was immediately visible. She **restructured the teams, clarified roles, and created a stronger organisational framework**. Projects that had previously relied on improvisation became more structured, and members understood their responsibilities more clearly.

The following year, I applied for the position of Talent Manager. I want to be clear about this: I would not have applied without her encouragement. She pushed me to challenge myself and take on responsibilities beyond anything I had done before. This is a rare quality in a leader — recognising potential in others before they see it themselves and creating opportunities for them to grow.

In that role, I was responsible for capacity building, strengthening team unity through activities and culture-building initiatives, representing HIH at the National Community Service Club Conference, where I presented the club's vision and projects, and speaking at our own conference about leadership, teamwork, and community impact. Afnane supported these efforts through regular follow-ups, meetings, and by understanding what each member needed to succeed. Volunteers are not required to stay; they stay when they feel valued and supported.

The impact of her leadership was visible in two ways: public school students improved their English skills and confidence, while our members developed personally and professionally, gaining skills they carried into their future careers. Achieving both outcomes simultaneously requires intention, and Afnane created an environment where it was possible.

The clearest measure of her leadership, in my opinion, is what happened after she left. Afnane stepped down from HIH CSC in **2023**, and I took over as Vice President. The structure she created remained strong. The teams continued to function effectively, and the standards she established continued beyond her presence. Many leaders are successful while they are present; fewer leave behind **systems that continue to work** after they leave.

On a personal note, the lessons I learned from working alongside Afnane have continued to benefit me professionally and personally. I recommend her sincerely and without reservation for **future leadership opportunities**. Anyone capable of building and leading a volunteer organisation — where authority comes entirely from trust, commitment, and example rather than obligation — will be well prepared to handle the responsibilities of a professional role.

I would gladly work with her again, and I remain available to answer any further questions.

With best regards,

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Vice President (2023), Talent Manager (2022–2023)
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